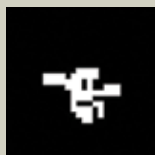


Downwell



In Downwell, well, you go down a well. What is the goal? Before you die, make the most stylish run you can. You've got guns strapped to your feet, and bullets do more than just kill foes; they also assist you hover in the air for important repositioning. The levels themselves are retro and primarily monochromatic, with a few red splashes thrown in for good measure. The vertical orientation effectively conveys a sense of falling. It's crazy to assume that a developer would go to this level of retro nuance while looking at the attention to detail that went into Downwell. Everything about it is a love letter to the foundations of early gaming, from the chiptune soundtrack to the dithered visual effect transitions to the faux-NES style lag that occurs.



Furthermore, the gameplay is easily one of the best arcade action platformers we've ever played. Starting the game, leaping down, and seeing how long you can live on your restricted life is the gameplay cycle. When you collide with an enemy, run into spikes, or come into contact with anything else that damages you, you lose life until you die. When you die, you return to the top of the well and jump down. The multiple graphic styles and colour palettes you unlock are the only things that remain. On your descent down the well, there will be small offshoots on either side every now and then. Going into one usually results in some kind of power-up that recovers some health and changes the way you shoot. Some power-ups provide you a wide range of effects, while others, such as the laser, fire a beam straight down. There are also businesses along the way where you may use your gems to acquire more health, ammunition or more.

Crossy Road

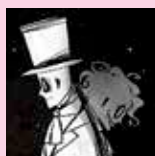


This ongoing Frogger-style game keeps you on your toes by putting various automobiles, trucks, trains, and logs in your way to see how far your character can get. Coins can be collected along the route, but they're usually earned by watching advertisements and waiting for your free present, which appears every few hours. These coins are used in the quarter-toy machine to test if any new characters appear. You can also customise the game's ambiance by selecting from a variety of animals, toys, people, and even robots. Each character has a distinct feel, such as a hilarious noise or motion, but in the end, they all move in the same way. They come in a broad variety of shapes and sizes, ranging from a chicken to a basketball player. Some of the characters also alter the game's land-



scape. The Ghost, for example, casts a pall over the highway. The graphics are plain 8-bit nostalgia, but they blend well with the game. The animations are fluid, with very little, if any, skipping. For new characters, this free-to-play game uses micro-transactions. There are 110 total characters in the game, with some claimed to be "hidden unlockables" that can only be obtained by completing a specific mission. While in-app purchases are available, just a few characters are purchase-only, thanks to a clever design that allows players to unlock characters by spending "coins" in an in-game "prize machine." This is one of those odd games that you start playing, only to never get enough and stop playing. Crossy Road is extremely great at passing the time while still remaining engaging. It capitalises on the insatiable need to beat one's own high score, and its simple, entertaining nature encourages multiple attempts.

MazM: Jekyll and Hyde



MazM: Jekyll and Hyde is an iOS and Android detective mobile game. MazM: Jekyll and Hyde is based on Robert Louis Stevenson's renowned work 'Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde'. MazM: Jekyll and Hyde is a long story involving two people, Doctor Jekyll and a man named Hyde who lives in London. The two characters, who appear to be unrelated, enjoy a tight connection. Players will gather clues to figure out how these two people are related, as well as a celestial secret that has been buried all along. In fact, the classic novel Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde, published in 1886, is rather selective about its readers due to the twisted occurrences, but it is simpler to digest when it is included in the game scenario. The clues are woven into the clever tale, allowing players to easily



become engrossed in the game's emotional circuit. This is also something we value in MazM: Jekyll and Hyde, as opposed to a solely horror-detective game. The graphics of the game are designed in the style of 'classic' cartoons from the 1930s. The figures' movements are all hand-drawn. Partly because this is a game with a mystery horror colour palette, and partly because the game takes place in 19th-century London, the animation details are rich in historical hues. In terms of music, Jekyll and Hyde has put a lot of effort into it; players will hear a variety of music throughout the game, depending on the situation. MazM: Jekyll and Hyde's gameplay is similar to those of other detective games in which players complete missions and collect clues in order to discover the ultimate final answer. Overall, if you are a true lover of the franchise rather than a casual observer, you will definitely enjoy MazM: Jekyll and Hyde.